

Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

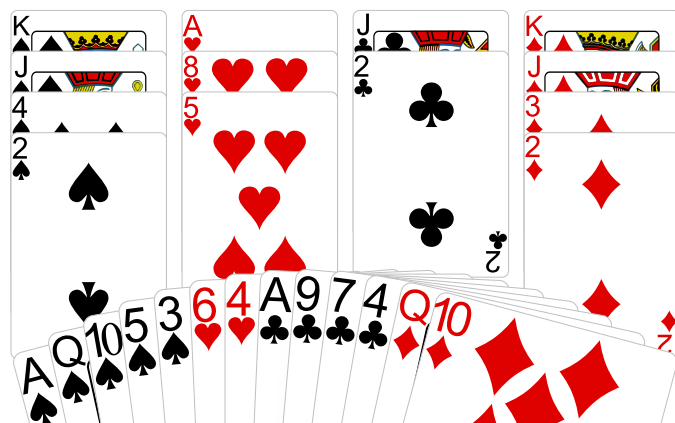
Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

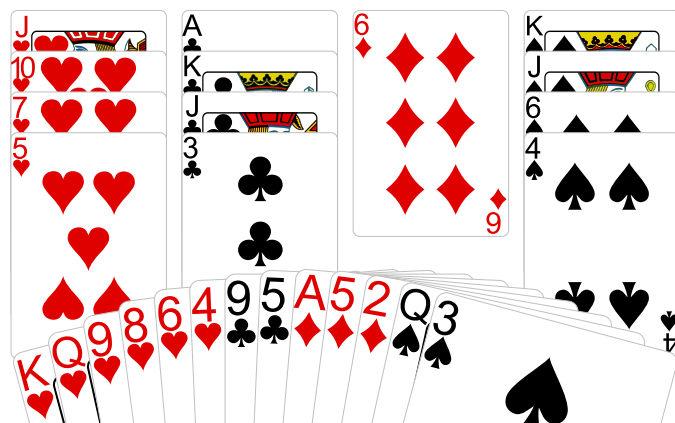
- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Deal 1 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



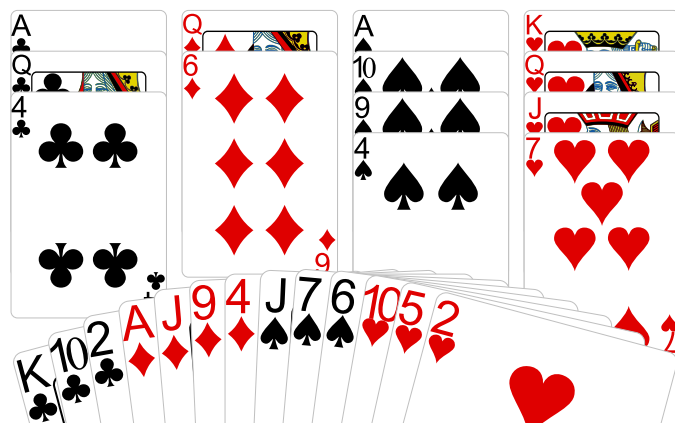
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



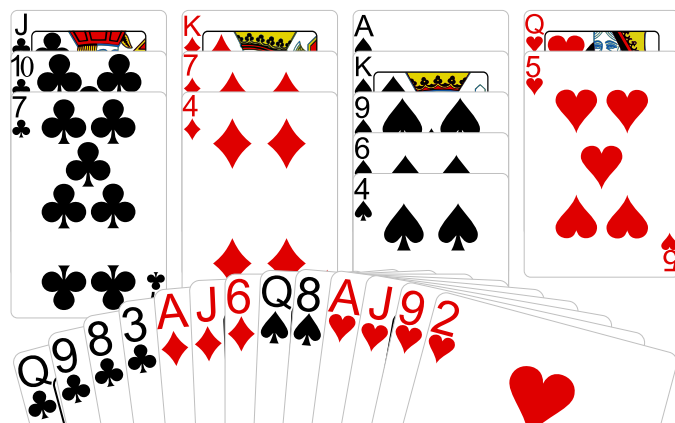
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 7
 ♥ Q 7 3 2
 ♦ 9 8 4
 ♣ K Q 6 3

♠ A Q T 5 3

♥ 6 4

♦ Q T

♣ A 9 7 4



♠ 9 6
 ♥ K J T 9
 ♦ A 7 6 5
 ♣ T 8 5

♠ K J 4 2

♥ A 8 5

♦ K J 3 2

♣ J 2

West

1 ♥

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

North

1 ♠

4 ♠

East

Pass

South

3 ♠

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 13 points NORTH should overcall 1 ♠.

SOUTH has 13 points and four ♠s. If NORTH had opened, SOUTH's hand would be good enough to insist on game. But since NORTH overcalled, SOUTH merely invites with a jump to 3 ♠.

NORTH has better than a minimum overcall so she accepts the invitation and bids 4 ♠.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 6 4

♥ J T 7 5

♦ 6

♣ A K J 3

♠ A 5 2

♥ A 3

♦ K J 8 3

♣ Q 8 7 4



♠ Q 3

♥ K Q 9 8 6 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 9 5

♠ T 9 8 7

♥ 2

♦ Q T 9 7 4

♣ T 6 2

WEST has a very minimum Takeout Double of 1♦.
But what it lacks in strength, it makes up for with perfect distribution.

EAST has 13 points and only wants to play in one contract, 4♥.

WEST passes happily.

West

North

East

South

1♦

Dbl

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 5
 ♥ 9 8 3
 ♦ K T 7
 ♣ J 9 8 3

♠ A T 9 4
 ♥ K Q J 7
 ♦ Q 6
 ♣ A Q 4



♠ 8 3 2
 ♥ A 6 4
 ♦ 8 5 3 2
 ♣ 7 6 5

♠ J 7 6
 ♥ T 5 2
 ♦ A J 9 4
 ♣ K T 2

NORTH has 18 points, a doubleton in the opponent's suit, and at least three cards in the unbid suits. This is an ideal hand for a Takeout Double.

SOUTH has good strength in WEST's ♦ suit, probably two stoppers. He has 9 points and no 4-card suit of his own. This is the type of hand to respond 1NT.

NORTH is happy to play Notrump now that she knows the ♦s are covered, so she bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Dbl	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 8
 ♥ A J 9 2
 ♦ A J 6
 ♣ Q 9 8 3

♠ J 5 2
 ♥ K 7 4 3
 ♦ 9 5 3
 ♣ A K 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 9 6 4
 ♥ Q 5
 ♦ K 7 4
 ♣ J T 7

♠ T 7 3
 ♥ T 8 6
 ♦ Q T 8 2
 ♣ 6 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	1 ♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			

EAST has an opening hand, 14 points and five ♠s. But NORTH beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

WEST also has 14 points, she doesn't care too much for ♠s, but she has an excellent stopper in ♥s. She jumps to 2NT, inviting EAST to bid game.

Since EAST has several points more than he might have had, and no 6-card ♠ suit to rebid, he happily bids 3NT.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 5 2

♥ 4 2

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ 9 7 2

♠ 8 7

♥ K Q 9 7

♦ A K 8 3

♣ Q J 4



♠ K T 6 4

♥ A 8 6

♦ J T 6

♣ T 5 3

♠ A 9 3

♥ J T 5 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A K 8 6

NORTH has 15 points and all the requirements for a Takeout Double of 1♠.

With 14 points of his own, SOUTH knows his side needs to be in a game somewhere. He passes this information to NORTH with a cue-bid of 2♠.

NORTH gets the message and starts the hunt for a trump fit by bidding 3♥. That makes it easy for SOUTH - he bids 4♥.

West

1♠

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by North

North

Dbl

3♥

East

Pass

Pass

South

2♠

4♥